TROOP 3054 · SCOUT PACKET

Cooking Merit Badge

Badge Day: _____ · Camp Wakpominee Nov 20 to 22

SCOUT _____ COUNSELOR _____

HOW THIS PACKET WORKS

SECTION A · PAGES 3 TO 7

Meeting Teachings

What your counselor teaches on Badge Day, with space to take notes and get each part signed.

Reqs 1, 2, 3, 7

SECTION B · PAGES 8 TO 14

Logs

Your activity log, meal plans, shopping lists, budgets, home cooking log and meal ratings.

Reqs 2c, 4, 5a to 5c, 6a to 6c

SECTION C · PAGES 15 TO 16

Camp

Cooking at camp, cleanup, Leave No Trace, and your trail meals on the Sunday hike.

Reqs 4f, 5d to 5h, 6d to 6f

TWO RULES

1. **Badge meals count only for this badge.** Meals for reqs 4, 5 and 6 can't count for rank or anything else.
2. **Don't repeat a menu.** No menu can be repeated across the meals you cook for reqs 4, 5 and 6.

START HERE

- ☐ Get the Scoutmaster's OK to start the badge
- ☐ Start your 5-day activity log this week (page 8)
- ☐ Bring this packet to Badge Day

Badge Tracker

Every requirement, where it happens, and where it's signed. Your counselor initials here as you finish.

REQ	WHAT YOU DO	WHERE	PAGE	DATE	INITIALS
1a-e	Health and safety: hazards, first aid, food safety, allergies and illness, labels	A · Badge Day	4		
2a,b,d,e	Nutrition: MyPlate groups, oils and sugars, eating habits, label terms	A · Badge Day	5		
2c	Five-day activity log and one-day meal plan	B · Log	8-9		
3a-d	Cooking basics: ten methods, stove vs fire, timing, taste and texture	A · Badge Day	6		
4a-b	Plan 3 days of home meals plus a dessert; recipes, shopping list, cost	B · Log	10		
4c	Counselor reviews home plan BEFORE you cook	B · Log	10		
4d-e	Cook breakfast, lunch, dinner and dessert at home; 5 of 10 methods; on time	B · Log	11		
4f	Ratings, self-evaluation, and talk it over with your counselor	B / C	11, 15		
5a-b	Plan camp menu for up to 8: 2 breakfasts, lunch, dinner, snack, dessert; budget	B · Log	12		
5c	Counselor reviews camp menu and shopping list	B · Log	12		
5d	Cook 2 meals on a stove, 1 in skillet or Dutch oven over coals, 1 in foil or on a skewer	C · Camp	15		
5e	Make and serve a snack and a dessert outdoors	C · Camp	15		
5f	Ratings, self-evaluation, discuss with counselor	B / C	14, 15		
5g	Lead cleanup after each meal	C · Camp	15		
5h	How you followed Leave No Trace and the Outdoor Code	C · Camp	15		
6a-b	Plan trail breakfast, lunch, dinner, snack for 3 to 5; no cooler; cost per meal	B · Log	13		
6c	Counselor reviews trail plan, including how you repackage food	B · Log	13		
6d	On a hike, make and serve 2 meals and a snack (1 meal cooked)	C · Hike	16		
6e	Ratings, self-evaluation, discuss with counselor	C · Hike	16		
6f	Sharing the load, cleaning the cook area, storing food from animals	C · Hike	16		
7	Cooking career or hobby research and discussion	A · Badge Day	7		

When every line is initialed, your counselor signs your blue card or records the badge in Scoutbook. That is the official record.

Badge Day Plan

The teaching happens in one session with your counselor. Come ready, leave with your home meal plan approved.

Badge Day date _____ Time _____ Place _____

Before

- [ ] Get the Scoutmaster's OK to start
- [ ] 5-day activity log (p. 8)
- [ ] One-day meal plan (p. 9)
- [ ] Pick your req 7 path and research it (p. 7)
- [ ] Draft your home meal plan, shopping list and cost (p. 10)
- [ ] Optional: draft camp and trail menus (p. 12, 13)

On Badge Day

- [ ] Req 1 Health and safety (p. 4)
- [ ] Req 2 Nutrition, with your log and meal plan (p. 5)
- [ ] Req 3 Cooking basics (p. 6)
- [ ] Req 7 Careers or hobby (p. 7)
- [ ] 4c Home meal plan approved (p. 10)
- [ ] 5c, 6c Camp and trail menus reviewed if ready

After

- [ ] Cook 4 home meals; an adult signs each one (p. 11)
- [ ] Get camp and trail menus approved before camp, by phone or email if needed
- [ ] Camp Wakpominee, Nov 20 to 22: camp cooking (p. 15) and trail meals on the Sunday hike (p. 16)
- [ ] Final sign-off on the Badge Tracker (p. 2)

Heads up: you can't cook your home meals until your plan is approved. Bring a finished home meal plan to Badge Day, or email it to your counselor to get it approved sooner.

Bring to Badge Day: this packet with pages 7 to 10 filled in, a pencil, and any food labels you want to talk about.

NOTES

Health and Safety Req 1 · Badge Day

The notes are reference for your discussion with the counselor. The sign-offs are the requirement.

1A · HAZARDS AND HOW TO HANDLE THEM

HAZARD	PREVENT IT
Burns and scalds	Pot handles turned in, dry hot pads, steam away from you
Cuts	Sharp knife, cut away from you, stable cutting board
Fire and stoves	Clear area, water nearby, never leave it, cool before refueling
Food poisoning	Clean hands, keep cold food cold, cook to safe temps
Allergic reactions	Ask everyone first, read labels, separate utensils

1B · FIRST AID

- **Burns:** cool with cool running water for 10+ minutes. Cover loosely. Don't pop blisters. Serious burn: call 911.
- **Cuts:** firm pressure with a clean cloth, wash with soap and water, bandage.
- **Choking:** if they can't cough, talk or breathe, give abdominal thrusts until it comes out. Call 911 if they become unresponsive.
- **Allergic reaction:** hives, swelling, trouble breathing. Help them use their epinephrine auto-injector and call 911.

1C · FOOD SAFETY

- **Danger zone** is 40 to 140°F. Refrigerate within 2 hours (1 hour above 90°F).
- **Safe temperatures:** poultry 165°F · ground meat 160°F · steaks, chops, fish 145°F · eggs until firm
- **Cross-contamination:** separate boards and plates for raw meat; wash hands and tools after touching it.
- Store eggs, dairy and meat cold. Wash fresh vegetables.

1D · ALLERGIES, INTOLERANCE, ILLNESS

- **Allergy:** immune reaction; can be life-threatening
- **Intolerance:** digestive trouble, like lactose
- **Food-related illness:** from germs in unsafe food
- Anyone preparing food for others needs to know all three

1E · FOOD LABELS AND ALLERGENS

- The requirement names seven common allergens: peanuts, tree nuts, milk, eggs, wheat, soy, shellfish. U.S. labels also flag fish and sesame.

SIGN-OFFS

REQ	COVERED	DATE	INITIALS
1a	Hazards: anticipate, prevent, respond		
1b	First aid for burns, cuts, choking, allergic reactions		
1c	Storing, transporting, preparing fresh foods; cross-contamination		
1d	Food allergies, intolerance, food-related illness; why food handlers need to know		
1e	Food labels and allergens		

Nutrition Req 2 · Badge Day

The notes are reference for your discussion with the counselor. The sign-offs are the requirement.

2A · MYPLATE GROUPS (daily amounts for about 2,000 to 2,400 calories)

GROUP	PER DAY	ONE SERVING IS	MY 5 EXAMPLES
Fruits	2 cups	1 cup fruit or juice; ½ cup dried	
Vegetables	2½ to 3 cups	1 cup raw or cooked; 2 cups leafy greens	
Grains	6 to 8 oz	1 slice bread; ½ cup rice or pasta; 1 cup cereal	
Protein	5½ to 6½ oz	1 oz meat or fish; 1 egg; 1 Tbsp peanut butter; ¼ cup beans	
Dairy	3 cups	1 cup milk or yogurt; 1½ oz cheese	

2B · LIMIT OILS AND SUGARS

- Added sugars: under 10% of daily calories
- Saturated fat: under 10% of daily calories
- They add calories without much nutrition
- Choose water, fruit, and oils like olive or canola in small amounts

2D · MY EATING HABITS

How you eat now, and what you can do to eat healthier based on MyPlate.

One change I'll make:

_____

_____

2E · LABEL TERMS

Calories	energy in one serving
Fat	total fat, all kinds
Saturated fat	limit; raises cholesterol
Trans fat	avoid as much as possible
Cholesterol	from animal foods
Sodium	salt; most of us eat too much
Carbohydrate	main energy source
Dietary fiber	helps digestion; aim higher
Sugar	watch added sugars
Protein	builds and repairs muscle

Two servings: double every number. One serving has 23 g carbs, so two servings have 46 g.
My label: ____ g carbs × 2 = ____ g

SIGN-OFFS

2a	Food groups and servings			2b	Oils and sugars		
2c	Log and meal plan (p. 8, 9)			2d	Eating habits*		
2e	Label terms			Initial and date each box			

*The requirement printed on Scouting.org repeats 1d here. The official workbook uses the eating-habits wording. Your counselor decides which to use.

Cooking Basics Req 3 · Badge Day

The filled-in columns are reference. You supply a food for each method and discuss each item with your counselor.

3A · TEN COOKING METHODS

METHOD	EQUIPMENT	HOW HEAT IS CONTROLLED	A FOOD I'D COOK THIS WAY
Baking	Oven or Dutch oven	Oven dial; coals on the lid	
Boiling	Pot with water	Big rolling bubbles, high heat	
Broiling	Oven broiler	Heat from above; rack distance	
Pan frying	Skillet and a little oil	Medium heat; flip once	
Simmering	Pot	Small bubbles; turn heat down	
Microwaving	Microwave	Power level and time	
Air frying	Air fryer	Set temperature and timer	
Grilling	Grill grate over coals or gas	Distance from heat; vents	
Foil cooking	Heavy foil packet in coals	Coal bed depth; turn the pack	
Dutch oven	Cast-iron pot, coals top and bottom	Number of coals; more on top to bake	

3B · CAMP STOVE VS. CHARCOAL OR WOOD FIRE

CAMP STOVE	CHARCOAL OR WOOD
Lights fast, easy to control	Takes time to build good coals
Works during fire bans	Not allowed during bans
No smoke, little impact	Needs a fire ring and fuel
Best for boiling, frying	Best for foil, Dutch oven, grilling

3C · TIMING A MEAL

Work backward from when you'll serve.

DISH	COOK TIME	START AT

Serve at: _____

3D · TASTE, TEXTURE AND SMELL

Reference: five tastes are sweet, salty, sour, bitter and savory. Smell does much of the work. Explain with your own examples.

SIGN-OFFS

3a	Ten methods			3b	Stove vs. fire		
3c	Meal timing			3d	Taste, texture, smell		

Name: _____

Careers or Hobby Req 7 · Badge Day

Pick one option. Research it before Badge Day and talk it through with your counselor.

☐ Option 7a · A cooking career

Name three food-related careers, then research one. Ideas: chef, baker, dietitian, food scientist, restaurant manager, food safety inspector.

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

CAREER I RESEARCHED	
Training and education	
Certification or licensing	
Experience needed	
Cost to get started	
Job outlook	
Starting pay	
How you move up	
Would I like it? Why?	

☐ Option 7b · Cooking as a hobby or healthy habit

QUESTION	MY ANSWER
How cooking fits my hobby or health	
Training or classes	
Costs	
Groups or clubs	
Short-term goal	
Long-term goal	

_____ _____

Counselor initials · Req 7 Date

5-Day Activity Log Req 2c · bring to Badge Day

This is about how much fuel your body needs for what you do. It is not a diet.

DAY	DATE	WHAT I DID AND FOR HOW LONG	ACTIVE MIN	LEVEL (CIRCLE)	CALORIES
1				S M A	
2				S M A	
3				S M A	
4				S M A	
5				S M A	

Activity level

S · Sedentary. Everyday moving only: school, chores, getting places.

M · Moderately active. Plus about 30 to 60 minutes of activity, like a brisk walk, bike ride or practice.

A · Active. Plus more than about 60 minutes of activity.

Calories per day

AGE	BOYS			GIRLS		
	SEDENTARY	MODERATE	ACTIVE	SEDENTARY	MODERATE	ACTIVE
12	1,800	2,200	2,400	1,600	2,000	2,200
13	2,000	2,200	2,600	1,600	2,000	2,200
14	2,000	2,400	2,800	1,800	2,000	2,400
15	2,200	2,600	3,000	1,800	2,000	2,400
16	2,400	2,800	3,200	1,800	2,000	2,400
17	2,400	2,800	3,200	1,800	2,000	2,400

Estimates from the Dietary Guidelines for Americans (USDA and HHS). Your own needs may be higher or lower.

Name: _____

My One-Day Meal Plan Req 2c · bring to Badge Day

Use your log to plan one day of meals that fits your activity level.

MY MOST COMMON LEVEL

S M A

MY DAILY NEED

_____ calories

Make half your plate fruits and vegetables, and hit all five food groups over the day.

Breakfast

☐ Fruits ☐ Veggies ☐ Grains ☐ Protein ☐ Dairy

Lunch

☐ Fruits ☐ Veggies ☐ Grains ☐ Protein ☐ Dairy

Dinner

☐ Fruits ☐ Veggies ☐ Grains ☐ Protein ☐ Dairy

Snacks

☐ Fruits ☐ Veggies ☐ Grains ☐ Protein ☐ Dairy

Every food group shows up at least once across the day. ☐ Yes

Counselor initials · Req 2c

Date

Name: _____

Home Meal Planner Req 4a to 4c

Plan three days of meals plus one dessert for you and at least one adult. Get it approved before you cook.

	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	DINNER
Day 1			
Day 2			
Day 3			
Dessert			

WHO I'M COOKING FOR

EQUIPMENT AND UTENSILS

ALLERGIES, SPECIAL DIETS, FOOD SAFETY PLAN

4B · SHOPPING LIST AND COST

ITEM	AMOUNT	COST	ITEM	AMOUNT	COST

Cost per meal: Breakfast $___ · Lunch $___ · Dinner $___ · Dessert $___

4c · Counselor approval before cooking

Counselor initials _____ Date _____

Home Cooking Log Req 4d to 4f · after approval

Cook and serve each meal from your plan, on time. Use at least five of the ten methods.

METHODS I USED (CHECK AT LEAST 5)

☐ Baking ☐ Boiling ☐ Broiling ☐ Pan frying ☐ Simmering ☐ Microwaving ☐ Air frying ☐ Grilling

☐ Foil ☐ Dutch oven

MEAL	DATE	WHAT I MADE AND HOW	LOOKS	TASTE	ADULT SIGNATURE
Breakfast			/5	/5	
Lunch			/5	/5	
Dinner			/5	/5	
Dessert			/5	/5	

4F · WHAT I LEARNED

What went well? What would you change? How did planning help?

4f · Talked it over with my counselor

Counselor initials _____ Date _____

Camp Menu Planner Req 5a to 5c

Plan for a patrol of up to 8 youth, including you, using MyPlate. You will cook two of the four meals on a camp or backpacking stove, one in a skillet over coals or a Dutch oven, and one in a foil pack or on a skewer.

Number of people: _____ · **Counselor ruling:** on this trip, a breakfast menu cooked Friday night counts as one of your two breakfasts.

MEAL	MENU	COOKING METHOD	EQUIPMENT
Breakfast 1			
Breakfast 2			
Lunch			
Dinner			
Snack			
Dessert			

5B · SHOPPING LIST AND BUDGET

ITEM	AMOUNT	COST	ITEM	AMOUNT	COST

Total cost: $_____ ÷ people: _____ **Cost per person: $_____**

5c · Counselor reviewed menu and shopping list

_____ _____

Counselor initials Date

Trail Menu Planner Req 6a to 6c

Plan for 3 to 5 people, including you. Light food that needs no cooler. You'll cook two of the meals and the snack on the trail.

MEAL	MENU	COST	COOKED OR NO-COOK?
Breakfast			
Lunch			
Dinner			
Snack			

At least one of the two meals you make on the trail must be cooked on a fire or trail stove.

EQUIPMENT AND UTENSILS

SHOPPING LIST

ITEM	AMOUNT

6C · REPACKAGING PLAN

How will you cut bulk, weight and trash? Example: pour pancake mix into a zip bag and leave the box at home.

6F · SPLITTING THE LOAD

PERSON	FOOD CARRIED	GEAR CARRIED

6c · Counselor reviewed trail plan and repackaging

Counselor initials _____ Date _____

Meal Ratings Req 5f, 6e

After each meal, ask the people you served to rate it 1 to 5. Then add your own take.

MEAL	RATED BY	LOOKS	TASTE	WHAT I'D CHANGE
Breakfast 1 CAMP		/5	/5	
Breakfast 2 CAMP		/5	/5	
Lunch CAMP		/5	/5	
Dinner CAMP		/5	/5	
Snack CAMP		/5	/5	
Dessert CAMP		/5	/5	
Trail meal 1 TRAIL		/5	/5	
Trail meal 2 TRAIL		/5	/5	
Trail snack TRAIL		/5	/5	

HOW PLANNING HELPED (5F, 6E)

Name: _____

Cooking at Camp Req 5d to 5h

In the outdoors, using your camp menu and recipes (page 12). Serve your patrol or a group of youth.

MEAL	METHOD	WHICH MEAL	DATE	COOKED + SERVED	LED CLEANUP	INITIALS
Meal 1	Camp or backpacking stove			☐	☐	
Meal 2	Camp or backpacking stove			☐	☐	
Meal 3	Skillet over coals or Dutch oven			☐	☐	
Meal 4	Foil pack or skewer			☐	☐	
Snack	Outdoors			☐	☐	
Dessert	Outdoors			☐	☐	

5G · LEADING CLEANUP

After each meal you lead:

- ☐ Cleanup of equipment and utensils
- ☐ Cleanup of the cooking site
- ☐ Storing or disposing of unused ingredients and leftovers
- ☐ Disposing of dishwater
- ☐ Disposing of garbage

5H · LEAVE NO TRACE AND THE OUTDOOR CODE

Reference:

1. Plan ahead and prepare
2. Travel and camp on durable surfaces
3. Dispose of waste properly
4. Leave what you find
5. Minimize campfire impacts
6. Respect wildlife
7. Be considerate of others

Outdoor Code: clean in my outdoor manners, careful with fire, considerate in the outdoors, conservation-minded.

How my cooking followed them:

_____

_____

_____

TALK IT THROUGH WITH YOUR COUNSELOR AT CAMP

4f	How your home meals went			5f	Camp meal ratings and lessons		
5h	Leave No Trace and Outdoor Code			Ratings go on page 14			

Trail Meals Req 6d to 6f

On the Sunday hike at Camp Wakpominee. Bring your trail menu and repackaged food from page 13.

Date _____ Trail _____ Adult leader _____

6D · MAKE AND SERVE TWO MEALS AND A SNACK

ITEM	WHAT I MADE	FIRE OR STOVE?	SERVED TO	INITIALS
Meal 1				
Meal 2				
Snack		n/a		

At least one meal is cooked over a fire or on an approved trail stove, with supervision.

6E · RATINGS AND LESSONS

Record ratings on page 14. How did better planning and packing help on the trail?

6F · ON THE TRAIL

- ☐ Explained how we split food and gear (page 13)
- ☐ Cleaned the cooking area and packed out trash
- ☐ Stored food away from animals

Counselor initials · Req 6d to 6f _____ Date _____

LAST STEP

Bring this packet to your counselor to finish the Badge Tracker on page 2. Your counselor signs your blue card or records the badge in Scoutbook.